participatory planning in the country by guaranteeing greater autonomous plan participation from the states.

If we look at the tax reforms process, we see a general tendency of enabling the states to collect more and more taxes, the Value Added Tax (VAT) being a glaring example by which almost all states have been able to increase their gross tax revenue receipts. The cause will be served more once the economy goes for the proposed enactment of the Goods and Services Tax (GST) from the fiscal 2009–10.

Thus, we see an overall change in the mindset of the Central Government towards allocating more financial resources in favour of the states which has been also shown by the Tenth and Eleventh Plans.

THE CHANGING NATURE AND ROLE OF PLANNING

Led by various inter-connected and experience-based factors, a great many ***new elements*** have been included in the Indian planning process in recent years. Some of the new elements are too path breaking to reverse the very established thinking of planning in the country. Still some of them could be seen as the Government's attempt to address some of the long-standing and overdue criticisms of planning in India. The inclusion of the new ***methods*** and ***strategies*** of planning has gone to change the very ***nature***, ***role***, and the ***scope*** of planning in the country. It was the Tenth Plan which is credited of doing this. Many 'first time' initiatives were taken up by the Plan. Usually, the plan projections in India did talk about development in the recognised sectors, but here the Tenth Plan imaginatively forges ahead towards new goals—it was undoubtedly a historic moment. The new measures initiated by the Plan[99] which led to changes in planning may be seen as under:

1. The Role of State in Planned Development

It was for the first time that the Planning Commission not only went for a detailed talk on the states' concerns but also emphasised and recognised their role in the process of development planning (in Vol. III, Tenth Plan).